I have always wanted to entertain with both my batting and my fielding. I think in this day and age of professional sport there's so much control over everything that it's increasingly difficult for individuals to stand out. I'm all for professionalism, but everyone is petrified of stepping out of line in any way, lest they insult, I dunno, the sponsors or the administrators or the fans in some way.

Actually, it's more accurate to say: what the sponsors or administrators *think* will insult the fans. And so everyone toes the line, which results in predictable, by-the-numbers behaviour. But I reckon sports fans love nothing more than seeing a little individuality in their sport. As a tennis fan, for example, I'd love to hear what Roger Federer *really* feels like when he loses, rather than the usual safe media soundbyte he delivers.

Naturally, there have been times in my own career where I have held my tongue concerning an issue of team selection, or strategy, or even how good or bad the umpiring was. We players all have our opinions, and sometimes they clash with those of the administrators. I reckon it will always be so. The more prudent route is to keep your mouth shut, unless you like getting into a whole lot of trouble with the UCB and/or the ICC.

However, the one way in which I have been able to express myself is on the cricket pitch, a) with a bat, and b) in the field. In my fielding, which I'm proud to say has been among the best in the sport, I could express myself in the way I celebrated taking a catch.

Obviously a sport like cricket has a different ethos to football. The way footballers celebrate a goal would be a little over the top for the more conventional cricket, but I admit to taking a couple of cues from former Manchester United player Eric Cantona. I've supported United since I was a *laaitie*, and I loved the way that Cantona would just stand there with his trademark collar sticking up after scoring, gazing at the crowd for about 10 seconds. He would display some miraculous piece of footballing skill, like chipping the keeper from way outside the box … and then he would just stand there as the crowd went totally bananas. His was the ultimate expression of self-confidence.

I've celebrated in a number of ways over the years – from sticking out my tongue to tossing the ball away as soon as I'd caught it. Though I did put an end to that little habit after the 1999 World Cup semi-final. After that incident, I started putting the ball in my pocket right after I caught it.